

What Yonkers Residents Complain About — and What to Do About It

Findings from 9,697 public comments on the City of Yonkers' official Facebook and Instagram accounts, and a policy agenda drawn from them

Evidence base	9,697 comments · 2021 – 2026 · Facebook and Instagram
Findings drawn from	The six season-matched windows: 7,081 comments, 503 complaints
Issues identified	14 civic categories
Policies proposed	70 — five per issue, short and long term
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers

Executive summary

Residents post a great deal on the city's channels, and most of it is not complaint: of 4,291 comments carrying actual prose, 503 (11.7%) register as grievances. What those grievances concentrate on is remarkably stable.

Four themes carry 52% of every complaint: City Responsiveness & Accountability, Taxes & Cost of Living, Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping, Schools & Education. These are not event-driven spikes — they appear at or near the top of every period examined from 2021 to 2026. The issues that come and go (potholes, jobs, parking) tend to track what the city posted about that year rather than a shift in what residents care about.

The single most striking pattern is that the top of the list is not about any one service failing. It is about the city as an institution: whether anyone answers, and whether the money is accounted for. Residents raise responsiveness and taxes more than they raise crime, potholes and housing combined.

The cheapest fix available

One operational contradiction runs through three of the top issues at once. Residents are ticketed under alternate-side parking rules on streets the city never actually cleaned, and charged at meters on blocks where parking is suspended for snow. Fixing that — enforcement follows the sweeper, not the calendar — costs a policy memo rather than a capital budget, and defuses complaints across snow response, parking and city responsiveness simultaneously.

How to read the two numbers in this document

Findings here use the six season-matched windows (March–November 2021–2025 and March–July 2026): 503 complaints. A separate pooled view of every comment collected, including December through February, yields 895 complaints and puts snow and storm response first. Both are correct. The season-matched view is used for the findings because it cannot be distorted by which months happened to be sampled.

Part One: The Findings

What residents actually complain about, in their own words

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering March – November 2021-2025 and March – July 2026. Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

7,081 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **4,291** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **503 (11.7%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

What the numbers do and don't represent

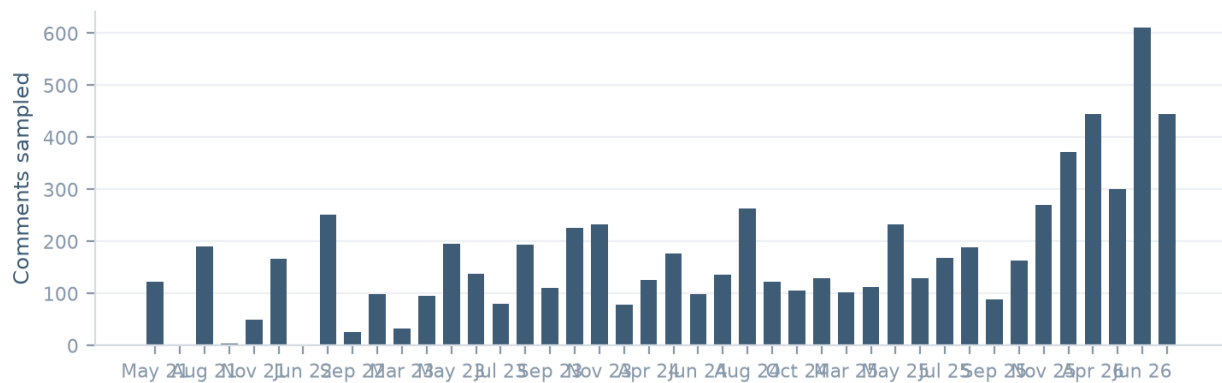
These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

- This document pools the six reporting windows into a single analysis: March-November 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025, plus March-July 2026. Months outside those windows - December, January and February, and August 2026 - are excluded, so this is the six periods analysed together rather than everything ever collected.
- Complaints by period: 2021 28, 2022 66, 2023 56, 2024 70, 2025 92, 2026 191. Volume rises steeply toward the present, so recent years carry this pooled ranking. For a like-for-like comparison across years, use the six period reports, where each period is normalised to its own share.
- Because every window runs March to November, winter is absent by construction. Snow, flooding and storm response therefore sits near the bottom here; in a pool that included December through February it ranks first. Neither figure is wrong - they answer different questions.
- Coverage is uneven across the span. Instagram's public feed could not be paged back past March 2023, so the 2021 and 2022 windows are Facebook-only, while later windows draw on both platforms.
- Facebook history was gathered as date-bounded slices rather than an exhaustive crawl, so each window is a sample of that period rather than every post the city published in it.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the most-commented posts in each window. Heavily discussed posts are over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram contributes the comments returned alongside each post, a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.

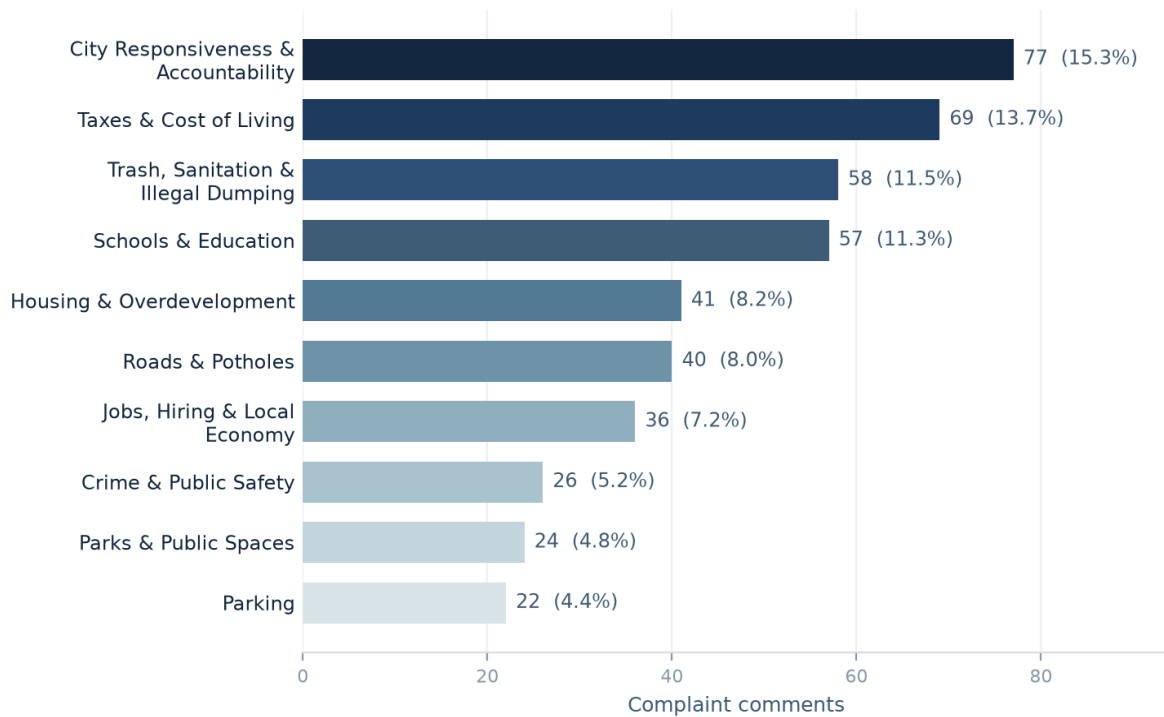
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited, not a census of civic opinion.

Comments sampled by month



The top 10 complaints

City Responsiveness & Accountability is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 15.3% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — City Responsiveness & Accountability, Taxes & Cost of Living, Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping — together make up 40% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

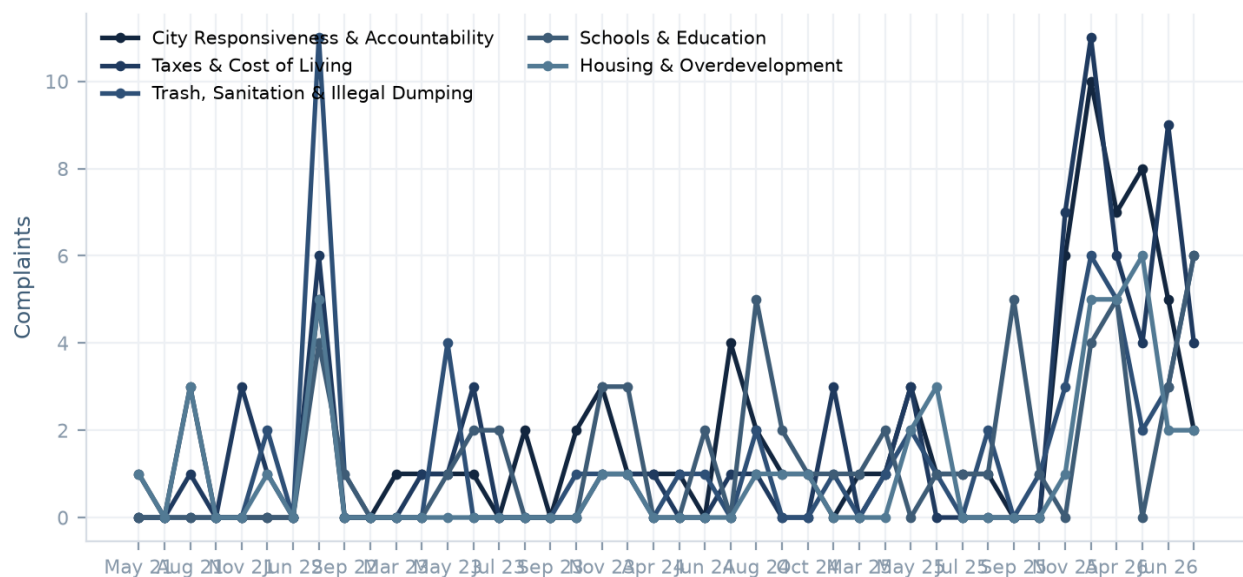


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	City Responsiveness & Accountability	77	15.3%	2.3
2	Taxes & Cost of Living	69	13.7%	4.1
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	58	11.5%	1.8
4	Schools & Education	57	11.3%	2.1
5	Housing & Overdevelopment	41	8.2%	2.6
6	Roads & Potholes	40	8.0%	3.6
7	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	36	7.2%	1.6
8	Crime & Public Safety	26	5.2%	0.4
9	Parks & Public Spaces	24	4.8%	1.8
10	Parking	22	4.4%	1.3

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read month-to-month movement with care. These lines track how much was sampled as much as how much was said — a month with few sampled comments cannot produce many complaints. Check the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any swing as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

City Responsiveness & Accountability

77 complaints · 15.3% of all complaints · Facebook 41 · Instagram 36



"The most corrupt city in New York State. How many members of the Spano Crime Family are profiting from the mayors control. Oh and I heard the mayor is already bribing the city council to give him another term since he can't find another job."

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "This week in Yonkers: Potholes getting filled Cherry blossoms starting to bloom Dispatche..."

"I had the chance of meeting him and we discussed Yonkers as a whole, this was in 2012. He and I talk about changing Yonkers and honestly I thought this guy is all talk and he's just talking bull like most people in office. I feel like he has out did my perception of him, Mayor Spano your doing a fantastic job keep up the good work."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is continuing the transformation of the former Mulford Gardens site. The new Park..."

"@— that is correct. The whole council is corrupt too. Sneaky moves are happening behind closed doors - Spano and his council are horrible corrupt individuals."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Did not expect the clock at Yonkers City Hall to look like this ■ Thanks to @mayormikesp..."

"Meanwhile the seniors are still in an unsafe building. Many have stopped going disgusted with all the empty promises and their ignored pleas. The promises made to them for a gazebo by July and a BBQ not fulfilled. We are entering fall. Where is the community in this picture? When will it be about the community? Sadly, it can not be until we have representatives that truly care about the people."

Facebook · 2021 · 12 likes · on: ">■ Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Coyne Park Fitness Station 771 McLean Avenue Yonkers, N..."

2

Taxes & Cost of Living

69 complaints · 13.7% of all complaints · Facebook 47 · Instagram 22



"We need lower property TAX, and better ROADS."

Facebook · 2026 · 14 likes · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"When will the income tax surcharge be eliminated You are bankrupting the citizens of Yonkers"

Facebook · 2025 · 4 likes · on: "Big win for Yonkers! ■■■ We're receiving \$10 million from Governor Hochul's Mid-Hudson M..."

"Financial accountability. What does the city do with the funds they grab from tax payers? Cost of living is ridiculous in this city run by a someone who seems to have most of his family on the payroll"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers, as we await the passage of New York State's Budget, this year's Executive Budget ..."

"All that Hollywood money pouring in and you still charge a residency tax on every paycheck and a leaving tax when you move out of Yonkers... crooked politicians in a crooked city!"

Facebook · 2025 · 3 likes · on: "Mayor Mike Spano toured the new Mediapro Studios on North Broadway with Robert Halmi the f..."

3

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

58 complaints · 11.5% of all complaints · Facebook 38 · Instagram 20



"Can we have a conversation about how filthy our streets are? Every road littered with trash, every exit ramp to any thruway, parkway or highway look worse than a garbage dump. Please do something."

Instagram · 2026 · 2 likes

"If this is true then why aren't summonses given to the apartment buildings and homes that put the recyclables out with the garbage. I see it everyday and watch the sanitation people take it with the garbage. This city doesn't uphold the recycling laws. I want a good answer not an excuse or it being passed on to the next guy"

Instagram · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "On #NationalRecyclingDay, Yonkers takes a stand for a cleaner, greener tomorrow! ■ Our P..."

"They are dumping garbage everywhere. Last week coming home I saw a stack of mattresses on central Avenue. Last year I saw on Facebook that someone dumped a truckload of used tires at a park in Yonkers. Really disgusting"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

"Great now they have to place cameras there. Unfortunately this dumping problem is everywhere. Mr. Spano you have to change those rules at the sawmill River Road sanitation dump site. People from Yonkers are willing to bring garbage there but they don't let them because of those strick rules and regulations. People have no clue where else to dump so that's why they dump everywhere around yonkers."

Facebook · 2022 · on: "Job well done! ■■■..."

4

Schools & Education

57 complaints · 11.3% of all complaints · Instagram 39 · Facebook 18



"GRADUATION RATE!!! Have you ever dealt with Yonkers Board of Education, the biggest pile of trash I've ever seen in my life! Biggest city in Westchester County with the worst school district ever! They don't care about these kids."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano (@mayormikespano) gives me the elevator pitch on the City of Yonkers and ..."

"Oh man what would our children's education do without a bunch of pedophiles guiding them while in school. How about paying teachers better and upping security. You people in office are not only a joke but you play dangerous games"

Instagram · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "This week, @mayormikespano swore in the incredible members of the Mayor's LGBTQ+ Advisory ..."

"Meanwhile the education and safety of student's etc in all of the Yonkers school system SUCKS ■■■■■!!"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Big news! ■ A cool investment in our children's future: The City of Yonkers and Yonkers P..."

"Oh please. And you wonder a large number of Yonkers Public Schools HS teens have failed at least one class during the 2021-22 school year. Also many vehicles are illegally parked in Yonkers with illegal license plate covers to evade enforcement cameras. #LiberalLogic #Idiocy"

Facebook · 2022 · 2 likes · on: "The New York State Office of Cannabis Management is hosting the "Get Ready, Get Set for Ca..."

5

Housing & Overdevelopment

41 complaints · 8.2% of all complaints · Facebook 26 · Instagram 15



"Why does he have to ask for school funding with all these building projects going up??? Cause our tax dollars are going into their pockets that's why!! Ridiculous to ask for funds should be getting funds from these billionaires putting up these high rises from the developers not tax payers!!! More buildings more traffic more crime more traffic!! But more money in their pockets ■"

Instagram · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "This week's Your Yonkers Now highlights the diversity of Yonkers plus more on the Mayor's ..."

"Hudson piers requires tenants to make 66 times the income for affordable housing. What a joke"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Is this the building that has been without heat for a year now- tenants are forced to cook with electric hobs. When Con Ed wanted the gas system replaced or would not pass the existing gas lines, without major modifications. Westchester Power should be able to give great rates, even though the landlord let the utilities fall into disrepair it seems"

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "A major investment in Yonkers housing is underway. A \$35 million project at Palisade Tower..."

"Mayor stop lying when you have landlords of building raising rent and throwing out tenant because they refuse to pay a 42 % increase"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

6

Roads & Potholes

40 complaints · 8.0% of all complaints · Facebook 24 · Instagram 16



"Fixing potholes? Try paving all streets instead of patching them for years. What a joke"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Yonkers, I've heard your concerns. After a tough winter, our crews have already filled ov..."

"Maybe try fixing the potholes, the roads are dangerous."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"How was the winter harsh? Stop spending taxpayers \$\$\$\$\$\$ in other places and fix the ALL the roads. Patching a road isn't considered fixing it, you are just putting a band-aid on it to do less work. #uselesspoliticians"

Facebook · 2021 · 6 likes · on: "The City of Yonkers fills over 3,000 potholes in over 70 different areas in two months!..."

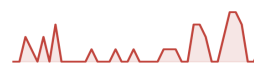
"Hope there is an update when some of these roads are getting paved???"

Instagram · 2024 · 5 likes · on: "Introducing Yonkers-Tron – our sleek new LED display sign on the Government Center Garage ..."

7

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

36 complaints · 7.2% of all complaints · Facebook 21 · Instagram 15



"Where are the jobs? I've been checking since they opened and have never seen them hiring"

Instagram · 2025 · on: "So excited to share the latest Hollywood on Hudson update with all of you! Yonkers isn't j..."

"Let's help kid our kids off the streets. We need summer programs jobs for teenagers. \nWhat's the money in that"

Facebook · 2026 · 11 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Where are the jobs ? Or does your last name have to end with Spano ?"

Facebook · 2025 · 9 likes · on: "Hollywood on Hudson is here! ■ Yonkers just launched a multi-platform ad campaign spotli..."

"Where are the jobs and why do our taxes keep going up"

Facebook · 2025 · 7 likes · on: "Hollywood on Hudson is here! ■ Yonkers just launched a multi-platform ad campaign spotli..."

8

Crime & Public Safety

26 complaints · 5.2% of all complaints · Facebook 13 · Instagram 13



"Police officer Patrick Creegan from 1st precinct is a disgrace to police officers. He is a pervert who exposes himself in public and has sex in his vehicle behind school yards and playgrounds. Sadly that's the bad apple of cops"

Facebook · 2021 · 1 likes · on: "Be A Hero Be the Change Take the Test ..."

"drugs & violence 2 blocks up in several directions lmaoo. what a joke."

Facebook · 2026 · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"We buy these garbage cans like we did with the ones that require the lids and every week they get stolen either either way you're getting screwed by criminals either it is the city issuing tickets or lowlife stealing the cans.."

Instagram · 2023 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today joined Yonkers Department of Public Works (DPW) Commissioner Thoma..."

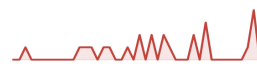
"She never worked that precinct as a cop , how can she be the commanding officer?"

Instagram · 2025 · on: "Today, I joined the Yonkers Police Department in celebrating the promotion of 10 of Yonker..."

9

Parks & Public Spaces

24 complaints · 4.8% of all complaints · Facebook 13 · Instagram 11



“■■ Yonkers parks are dirty and unkept. Trenchard st park is horrible. Unpainted basketball court. Broken glass on the courts and in the grass. Bottles and garbage all over. Broken tree branch's uneven concrete , the list goes on and on. So tell me how you love your parks ????? You should be ashamed you even posted this without looking at your parks.”

Instagram · 2023 · on: “It's #NationalParkWeek ! In Yonkers we■and appreciate our parks! During this week we will...”

“Scottie field needs too be updated like this , the grass is weeds n never cut down , infield dirt is filled with pebbles n rocks no benches for people to sit . No wonder no one plays baseball/softball down there anymore . But at least I have my childhood memories of JFK little league smh”

Facebook · 2025 · on: “Big news at Conor Park: Yonkers' first dog run is officially open! The renovation also br...”

“The park was so much better the way it used to be. The basketball court is nice but other than that, it should've stayed.”

Facebook · 2025 · 14 likes · on: “Welty Park is back and better than ever! Mayor Mike Spano joined community members to cel...”

“It would be nice if something was done for Kingsley Park on Chase Avenue. Many children play there everyday and the playground is rusted which is a health and safety hazard. Also, many people have been asking for a dog park there as well and nothing has been done. The City of Yonkers”

Facebook · 2023 · 6 likes · on: “>■Ribbon Cutting| State-of-the-Art Playscape at the Ridgeway Mixed-Income Residential Comm...”

10

Parking

22 complaints · 4.4% of all complaints · Facebook 15 · Instagram 7



“Ok what about the alternate side parking effects ?”

Facebook · 2021 · on: “Message from Mayor Mike Spano...”

“How about all the post office vehicles taking all the post office parking spots for its customers???”

Instagram · 2025 · on: “Double parking in Yonkers? It's not worth it. ■ In May alone, 3,405 tickets were issued ...”

“Also a lot of trucks parked there. They need to be towed so a sweeper can come by”

Facebook · 2022 · on: “■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan...”

“Glenwood Ave between Ravine and Glenwood station is a disaster of double parking on both sides of the street in the afternoons. It's impossible to get through some days. The city would make gobs of \$ if the law were only enforced. Never mind cars parked in NO PARKING areas overnight.”

Instagram · 2025 · on: “Double parking in Yonkers? It's not worth it. ■ In May alone, 3,405 tickets were issued ...”

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	City Responsiveness & Accountability	77	79	15.3%
2	Taxes & Cost of Living	69	81	13.7%
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	58	72	11.5%
4	Schools & Education	57	76	11.3%
5	Housing & Overdevelopment	41	53	8.2%
6	Roads & Potholes	40	45	8.0%
7	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	36	47	7.2%
8	Crime & Public Safety	26	28	5.2%
9	Parks & Public Spaces	24	27	4.8%
10	Parking	22	29	4.4%
11	Homelessness & Quality of Life	18	20	3.6%
12	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	15	19	3.0%
13	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	11	11	2.2%
14	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	9	11	1.8%

"Primary" counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. "Mentions" counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.

Part Two: The Agenda

A tagline and five policies for each of the fourteen issues

A Policy Agenda for Yonkers

A tagline and five practical policies for every issue residents raised on the City of Yonkers' social media, 2021 – 2026

Fourteen issues, ranked by how often residents raised them. Each carries a tagline, a line in a resident's own words, and five policies — some deliverable inside a year, some requiring a capital plan and a term of office. Policies are drafted from the specific streets, fees, parks and rules residents named, not from a generic municipal template.

These are proposals, not costed commitments. Nothing here has been through legal review, budget scoring, or a check against what the city is already doing. Treat it as an agenda to argue with.

The taglines at a glance

#	Issue	Tagline	Share
1	City Responsiveness & Accountability	Every Complaint Gets a Number	15.3%
2	Taxes & Cost of Living	End the Yonkers Surcharge	13.7%
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	Clean Streets, Every Block	11.5%
4	Schools & Education	Build Schools, Not Just Buildings	11.3%
5	Housing & Overdevelopment	Affordable Means Affordable Here	8.2%
6	Roads & Potholes	Pave It, Don't Patch It	8.0%
7	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	Yonkers Jobs for Yonkers Residents	7.2%
8	Crime & Public Safety	Guns Off Our Blocks	5.2%
9	Parks & Public Spaces	Every Park Playable	4.8%
10	Parking	No Ticket Without a Sweep	4.4%
11	Homelessness & Quality of Life	A Door for Everyone	3.6%
12	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	Plow Every Street, Not Just the Main Ones	3.0%
13	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	Light Every Corner	2.2%
14	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	Slow the Streets Down	1.8%

1

City Responsiveness & Accountability

77 complaints · 15.3% of all complaints

“Every Complaint Gets a Number”

Resident: “Financial accountability. What does the city do with the funds they grab from tax payers?”

Term	Policy
SHORT	A real 311 with a tracking number Every report gets a case number, an owner, and a status the resident can check without calling back.
SHORT	Publish response times by department and district A monthly scorecard showing how long each department takes to close cases, broken out by neighbourhood so no district is quietly served last.
SHORT	Answer the channels the city actually posts on Staff the comment threads. A large share of these complaints are questions the city never answered in the place they were asked.
LONG	Put the checkbook online A searchable register of contracts, vendors and payments over a set threshold, updated monthly. The corruption complaints here are mostly complaints about not being able to see anything.
LONG	Independent inspector general An office outside the mayor's control, with subpoena power and published findings, to investigate procurement and hiring.

2

Taxes & Cost of Living

69 complaints · 13.7% of all complaints

“End the Yonkers Surcharge”

Resident: “When will the income tax surcharge be eliminated? You are bankrupting the citizens of Yonkers.”

Term	Policy
SHORT	Publish a plain-language tax receipt Every property owner gets a one-page breakdown of where their money went, by service, each year.
SHORT	Expand and auto-enrol senior and veteran exemptions Most people who qualify never apply. Use records the city already holds to enrol them and backdate the relief.
LONG	Phase out the resident income tax surcharge Set a multi-year schedule to retire the surcharge, funded by growth in the commercial tax base rather than a service cut.
LONG	Grow the commercial base deliberately Tie development approvals to net new commercial ratables, so new buildings widen the tax base instead of shifting the burden onto existing homeowners.
LONG	Independent reassessment on a fixed cycle Regular, transparent reassessment stops the slow drift that leaves long-time owners paying a premium over recent buyers.

3

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

58 complaints · 11.5% of all complaints

“Clean Streets, Every Block”*Resident: “Every road littered with trash, every exit ramp to any thruway, parkway or highway looks a wreck.”*

Term	Policy
SHORT	Free bulk pickup on demand Most illegal dumping is mattresses and furniture. Make legal disposal easier and free to schedule, and the pile-ups fall.
SHORT	Cameras and real fines at the known dumping sites Residents can already name the spots. Enforce there first and publish the results.
SHORT	Adopt the ramps and trailheads A standing clean-up schedule for highway ramps and the Old Croton Aqueduct trail, which residents raise repeatedly and which fall between agency responsibilities.
LONG	Hold large buildings to the same rules as homeowners Summonses for apartment buildings that mix recycling and refuse, with escalating penalties for repeat offenders.
LONG	Containerised collection on the dense corridors Move from loose bags to shared containers on the busiest streets, which cuts both litter and the rat population.

4

Schools & Education

57 complaints · 11.3% of all complaints

“Build Schools, Not Just Buildings”*Resident: “It is great more housing is being built, but where are the children going to go to school?”*

Term	Policy
SHORT	Publish a school-capacity map beside every project No residential approval moves without the enrolment impact for the receiving schools printed in the public file.
SHORT	Get the trailers out of use first Fund and publish a dated plan to retire portable classrooms, starting with the most overcrowded schools.
LONG	A school-impact contribution on large residential projects Developments above a unit threshold contribute to classroom capacity in the district they fill.
LONG	A capital plan that tracks the housing pipeline Tie the school construction schedule to approved units, so capacity arrives with the residents rather than a decade later.
LONG	Competitive teacher pay and retention Yonkers competes with wealthier Westchester districts for the same teachers. Pay parity is the precondition for everything else on this list.

5

Housing & Overdevelopment

41 complaints · 8.2% of all complaints

“Affordable Means Affordable Here”*Resident: “Hudson Piers requires tenants to make 66 times the income for affordable housing. What a joke.”*

Term	Policy
SHORT	Set affordability to Yonkers incomes Peg income limits to the local median rather than a regional figure that prices out the residents the units are meant for.
SHORT	Publish every project's affordable split Unit counts, rent levels and income requirements posted plainly at approval. Residents did this arithmetic themselves - 225 market to 25 affordable - and were angry about what they found.
SHORT	One application for every affordable unit in the city A single waiting list and portal instead of per-building lotteries that reward whoever hears first.
LONG	Raise the mandatory affordable share on upzoned sites If the city grants the density, the public gets more than a token set-aside.
LONG	Permanent affordability and anti-harassment enforcement Long deed restrictions so units cannot convert to market rate, with a funded office to enforce against landlord harassment.

6

Roads & Potholes

40 complaints · 8.0% of all complaints

“Pave It, Don't Patch It”*Resident: “Patching a road isn't considered fixing it.”*

Term	Policy
SHORT	Publish the paving list before the season Every street scheduled for the year, posted in advance, with completion dates marked off as work finishes.
SHORT	Guaranteed pothole turnaround A published deadline from report to repair, with the count of missed deadlines reported monthly.
SHORT	Make utilities restore full width Require full-width repaving after utility cuts instead of the trench patches that fail within a winter.
LONG	A funded multi-year resurfacing programme Rank every street by condition and fund a rolling schedule, so reconstruction replaces perpetual patching.
LONG	Fix the crossings while you pave Rebuild crosswalks, curb ramps and sidewalks as part of each paving job, including the arterials residents call unsafe to cross on foot.

7

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

36 complaints · 7.2% of all complaints

“Yonkers Jobs for Yonkers Residents”

Resident: “I have a union card and can't find no work... they only hire their own family and friends.”

Term	Policy
SHORT	Post every city job in one public place One portal, every opening, with closing dates and the number of applicants. The perception of a closed shop is fed by invisibility.
SHORT	Publish hiring outcomes For each posting, report applicants, interviews and hires by residency. Transparency is the cheapest answer to patronage complaints.
LONG	Local hire requirements on subsidised projects Any project taking a tax abatement commits to a Yonkers residency share for construction and permanent jobs, with clawbacks if missed.
LONG	Apprenticeships tied to the capital programme Route residents into the trades through the city's own paving, school and sewer work.
LONG	Storefront strategy for the commercial strips Targeted help for small business on the corridors residents name, rather than incentives concentrated on the waterfront.

8

Crime & Public Safety

26 complaints · 5.2% of all complaints

“Guns Off Our Blocks”

Resident: “A 15-year-old with a gun. How does someone that young get their hands on one?”

Term	Policy
SHORT	Focused deterrence on the small number driving violence Concentrate outreach and enforcement on the individuals and blocks that account for most shootings, rather than broad sweeps.
SHORT	Fund credible-messenger violence interruption Trained community workers who can defuse retaliation before it becomes the next shooting.
SHORT	Trace every recovered firearm and publish the results Show residents where guns are actually coming from, which is the question they keep asking.
LONG	Year-round paid youth employment The comments tie youth violence to having nothing to do. Steady paid work and late-night programming is the long-term answer.
LONG	Beat officers who stay on the same blocks Consistent assignment so officers and residents know each other, instead of rotating faces after every incident.

9

Parks & Public Spaces

24 complaints · 4.8% of all complaints

“Every Park Playable”*Resident: “The playground is rusted which is a hazard... unpainted basketball court, broken glass on the courts.”*

Term	Policy
SHORT	Safety sweep of every playground Inspect all equipment, publish the findings, and fix or close what is hazardous - residents named rusted equipment and glass on courts specifically.
SHORT	A published maintenance standard Set mowing, litter and court-resurfacing frequencies and report against them park by park.
SHORT	Report-a-problem code on every park sign A scannable code that files a tracked case, so a broken swing does not depend on knowing whom to call.
LONG	A rolling renovation programme worst-first Rank every park by condition and renovate on a published cycle, starting with the smaller neighbourhood parks that residents say are skipped.
LONG	Equity test on parks capital spending Publish investment per resident by neighbourhood, so waterfront showpieces cannot crowd out the parks people use daily.

10

Parking

22 complaints · 4.4% of all complaints

“No Ticket Without a Sweep”*Resident: “How can alternate side be enforced when there is nowhere to park on many streets?”*

Term	Policy
SHORT	Enforcement follows the sweeper, not the calendar Alternate-side tickets are only valid where cleaning actually happened that day. This is the single most repeated grievance in the data.
SHORT	Fix the meter contradiction When alternate-side is suspended for snow, suspend meter enforcement on the same blocks instead of charging for spaces nobody can reach.
SHORT	Notice before the ticket Push rule changes to text and email the evening before, and void tickets from any change announced with less than 12 hours' notice.
LONG	Residential permit parking in the squeezed neighbourhoods Where housing density outran the curb, permits give residents a realistic chance at a space near home.
LONG	Shared municipal garages in the dense corridors Build or lease structured parking so overnight demand comes off streets that cannot be cleaned while full.

11 Homelessness & Quality of Life

18 complaints · 3.6% of all complaints

“A Door for Everyone”

Resident: “We have over 800 homeless men and women here in Yonkers.”

Term	Policy
SHORT	Street outreach with a placement, not a move-along Teams that can offer a bed and a caseworker the same day.
SHORT	Enforce the noise rules people actually raise Set and enforce hours for leaf blowers and amplified sound, with a complaint route that produces a response.
SHORT	Public bathrooms and water in the busy parks Basic facilities remove a recurring quality-of-life flashpoint for everyone using the space.
LONG	Permanent supportive housing Housing paired with services is what ends chronic homelessness; shelter capacity alone recycles people through the system.
LONG	Homelessness prevention fund Emergency rent and arrears help, which is far cheaper than sheltering a family after eviction.

12 Snow, Flooding & Storm Response

15 complaints · 3.0% of all complaints

“Plow Every Street, Not Just the Main Ones”

Resident: “Side streets are icy, dangerous, and barely passable... Yonkers has many many hills.”

Term	Policy
SHORT	Pre-treat the hills before the first flake Publish a named list of steep-grade streets that get brined ahead of every forecast storm, and post completion times so residents can see it happened.
SHORT	Publish a live plow map GPS on every plow, feeding a public map showing when each street was last cleared. This ends the argument about whether a street was skipped.
SHORT	Never ticket a street the city hasn't cleaned Suspend alternate-side enforcement on any block that has not yet been plowed curb to curb, and void tickets issued on uncleaned streets automatically.
LONG	Buy snow melters for the dense corridors Residents proposed this directly. Melters let crews remove snow from narrow streets with nowhere to pile it, instead of pushing it into parked cars and crosswalks.
LONG	Rebuild drainage where flooding repeats Map every block that floods more than once in three years and put catch-basin and storm-sewer upgrades on a funded, published schedule.

13 Street Lighting & Infrastructure

11 complaints · 2.2% of all complaints

“Light Every Corner”

Resident: “Street lights should be fixed so they actually work. Also install new ones where there aren’t, like Agar St.”

Term	Policy
SHORT	Seven-day streetlight repair A published deadline from report to relight, with outages mapped publicly so nobody wonders if it was logged.
SHORT	Night audit of the dark blocks Walk the streets residents name after dark, and fill the gaps where no light was ever installed.
SHORT	Clear the sight lines Trim vegetation blocking lights and signs, and enforce against trucks parked where they block crossings and visibility.
LONG	City-wide LED conversion with smart outage reporting Fixtures that report their own failures, so repairs start before a resident has to complain.
LONG	Lighting standards in every capital project Fold pedestrian-scale lighting into paving, park and streetscape work rather than treating it as a separate ask.

14 Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving

9 complaints · 1.8% of all complaints

“Slow the Streets Down”

Resident: “Drivers always going through red lights, passing buses... drag racing... riding on the sidewalks.”

Term	Policy
SHORT	Daylight the dangerous corners Clear parking back from crossings at the intersections residents name, so drivers and pedestrians can see each other.
SHORT	Traffic calming where schools and crossings are Speed humps, raised crossings and signal timing prioritised around schools and bus stops.
SHORT	Target the dirt bikes and ATVs at the source Enforcement aimed at the sale, storage and fuelling of illegal off-road vehicles rather than street pursuits.
LONG	Redesign the arterials residents keep naming Road diets, protected crossings and median refuges on the corridors where speeding is chronic.
LONG	A published Vision Zero plan with a crash map Rank every intersection by injury history and fix them in order, reporting progress annually.